ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 56

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Amharic Alphabet

የአማርኛ ፊደል መጽሐፌ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 33 Amharic Letters with English Phonetics

ሀ ለ ሐ መ ሠ ረ

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Amharic Alphabet — የአማርኛ ፊደል መጽሐፌ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 56

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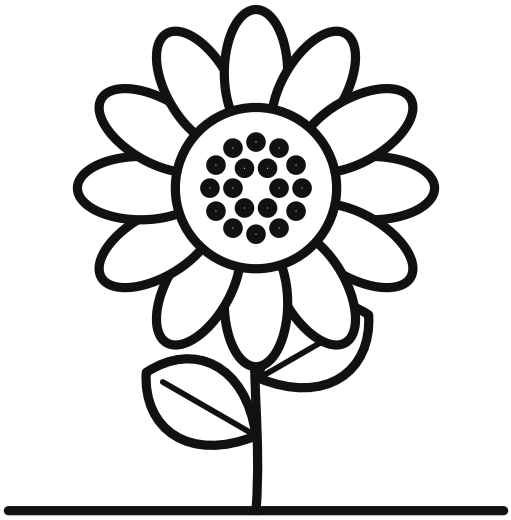
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

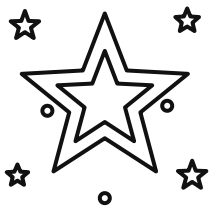
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

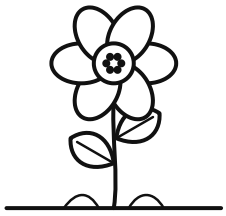


This book belongs to
ይህ መጽሐፍ የእኔ ነው

I started learning Amharic on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 56 is Amharic. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Vowels: **e** as in "the" · **u** as in "rule" · **i** as in "ski" · **a** as in "father" · **é** as in "café" · **o** as in "go". **(i)** is a very quick 'i', often silent.
- An **apostrophe after a consonant** (*q, t', ch', p', ts'*) marks a **popped** sound: hold your breath, then let it burst out.
- An apostrophe **between vowels** (*se-'at*) is a tiny catch in the throat, like the middle of "uh-oh".
- **ny** as in "canyon"; **zh** like the 's' in "measure". Hyphens split the syllables; say them all evenly.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Amharic name** written in Amharic (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *The … family · 7 sounds* shows the letter's **whole family**: the base letter and its six vowel forms, each with its sound. The shaded form is the one that starts the word on that page.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the Amharic of Addis Ababa.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Amharic! አማርኛ

a-ma-ri-nya — the Amharic word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **57 million people** speak Amharic: more than half of them from birth, the rest as a second language.[3]

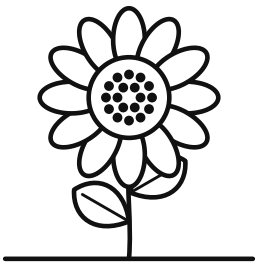
Where?
All over **Ethiopia**, in East Africa, especially in the highlands and the capital **Addis Ababa**, and in Ethiopian families around the world.

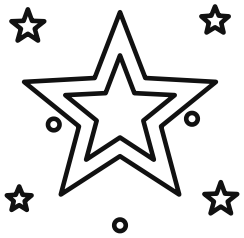
How is it written?
In the **fidel** (ፊደል), from **left to right**. Each letter is a whole syllable, like *ba* or *mo*.

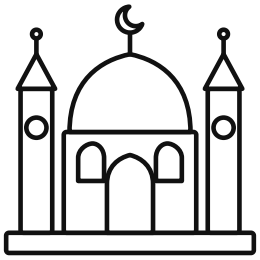
How many letters?
33 letter families, each with **7 forms**: more than 200 letters, all made from a few simple shapes!

Did you know?
The first Muslims to leave Makkah for safety travelled to **al-Ḥabasha** (Abyssinia), where the just king, **an-Najāshī**, welcomed and protected them.

13 months!
The Ethiopian calendar has **13 months**: twelve of 30 days and one short month, ጳጉሜ, of 5 or 6 days.







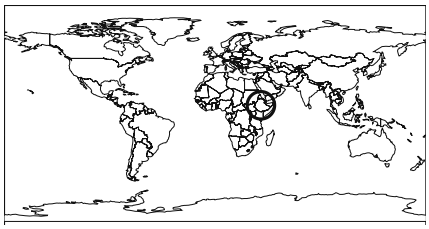
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Amharic Alphabet ፊደል

33 letter families – ፊደል

ሀ *ha*	ለ *le*	ሐ *hameru ha*	መ *me*	ሠ *negusu se*	ረ *re*	ሰ *isatu se*
ሸ *she*	ቀ *qe*	በ *be*	ቨ *ve*	ተ *te*	ቸ *che*	ኀ *bizuhanu ha*
ነ *ne*	ኘ *nye*	አ *alfaw a*	ከ *ke*	ወ *we*	ዐ *aynu a*	ዘ *ze*
ዠ *zhe*	የ *ye*	ደ *de*	ጀ *je*	ገ *ge*	ጠ *t'e*	ጨ *ch'e*
ጰ *p'e*	ጸ *ts'elotu ts'e*	ፀ *ts'ehayu ts'e*	ፈ *fe*	ፐ *pe*		

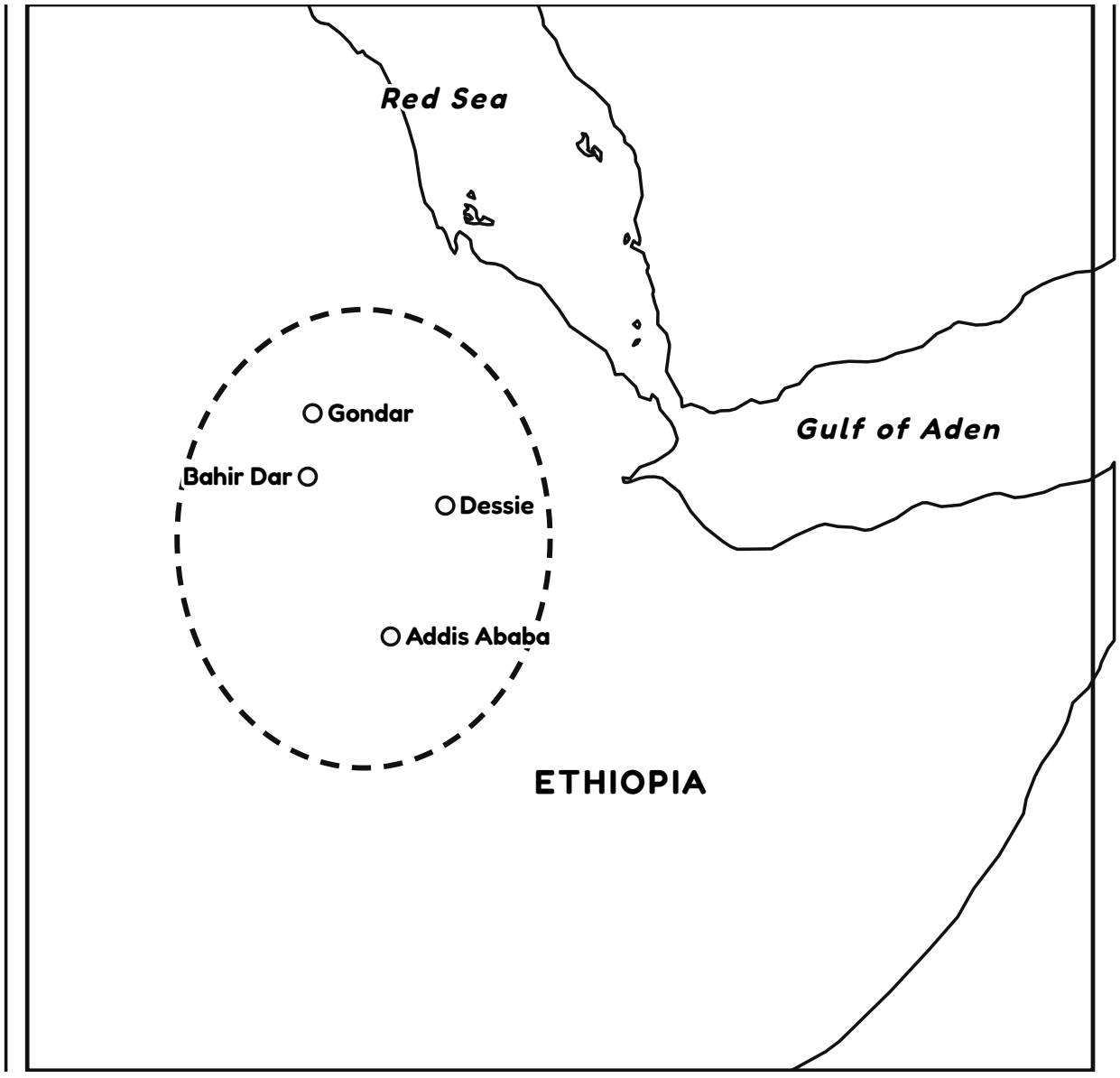
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Horn of Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Amharic spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the seas **blue**. **Find it:** Amharic is spoken all over Ethiopia. The dashed line shows the highlands around Gondar, Bahir Dar and Dessie, where most families speak it at home, and the capital, Addis Ababa.

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THE LETTER FAMILIES

The Fidel ፊደል

fi-del — “the letters”

Amharic is written with the **fidel** (ፊደል). Every letter stands for a whole **syllable**: a consonant *and* a vowel together. This book teaches **33 letter families**.

One family, seven sounds

Each family starts with its **base letter** (the 1st form). Small changes to its shape give six more forms, one for each vowel. Read the grid across: *le*, *lu*, *li*, *la*, *lé*, *l(i)*, *lo*.

1st ግዕዝ	2nd ካዕብ	3rd ሣልስ	4th ራብዕ	5th ኃምስ	6th ሳድስ	7th ሳብዕ
-e	-u	-i	-a	-é	-(i)	-o
ለ *le*	ሉ *lu*	ሊ *li*	ላ *la*	ሌ *lé*	ል *l(i)*	ሎ *lo*
መ *me*	ሙ *mu*	ሚ *mi*	ማ *ma*	ሜ *mé*	ም *m(i)*	ሞ *mo*
በ *be*	ቡ *bu*	ቢ *bi*	ባ *ba*	ቤ *bé*	ብ *b(i)*	ቦ *bo*
ሰ *se*	ሱ *su*	ሲ *si*	ሳ *sa*	ሴ *sé*	ስ *s(i)*	ሶ *so*

The forms are called ግዕዝ ካዕብ ሣልስ ራብዕ ኃምስ ሳድስ ሳብዕ (*ge'ez*, *ka'ib*, *salis*, *rabi'*, *hamis*, *sadis*, *sabi'*): 1st to 7th.

Spot the vowel marks

2nd: a little stroke on the right (ሉ) · 3rd: a foot on the right leg (ሊ) · 4th: a leg that grows or bends (ላ) · 5th: a little ring (ሌ) · 6th: a bent or broken leg (ል) · 7th: a ring or a shorter leg (ሎ).

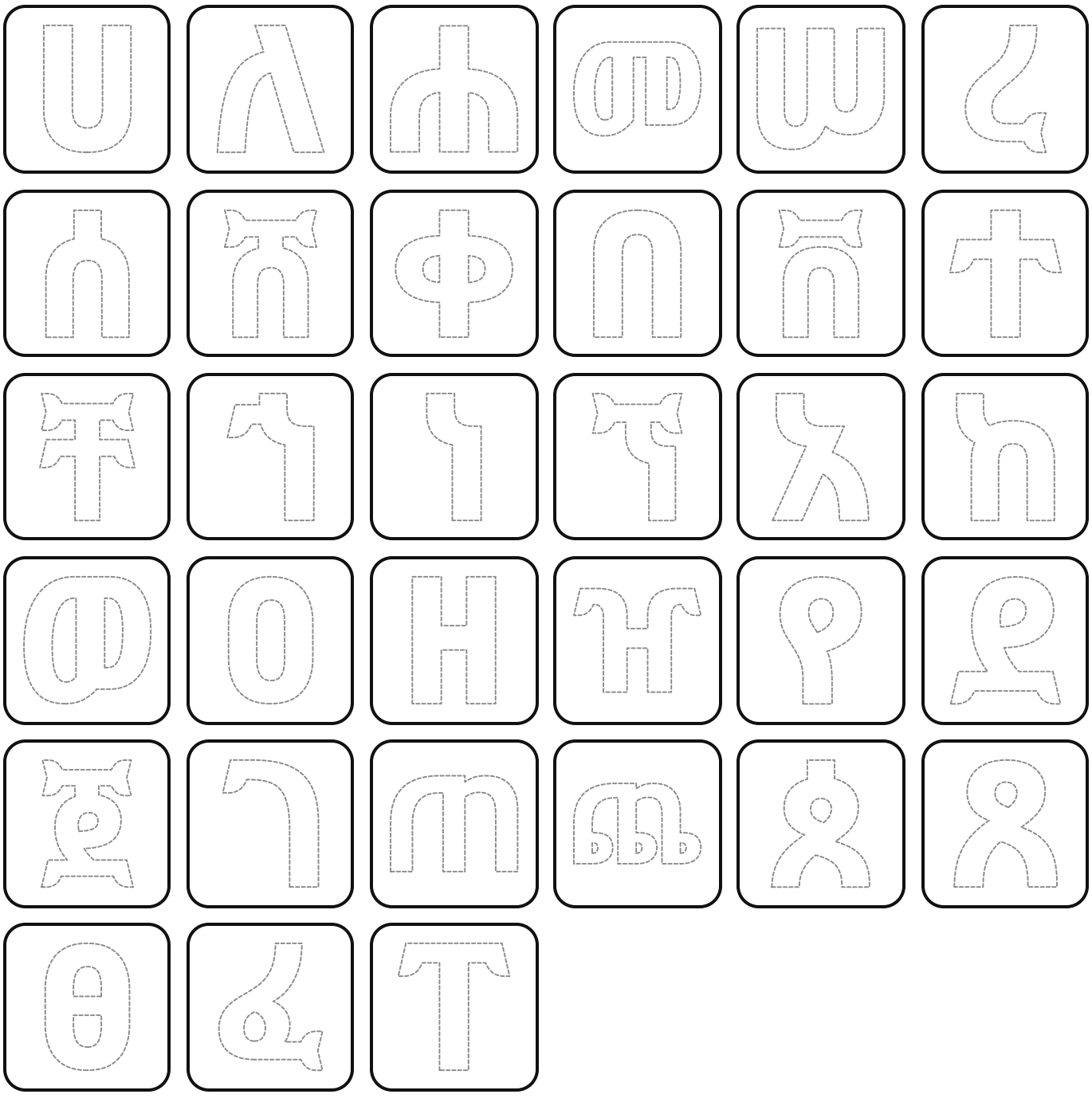
On every letter page

The big letter is the **base form**. The box *The … family · 7 sounds* shows all seven forms; the **shaded** one is the sound that begins the word on that page. Some families have an extra ‘-wa’ form too, like ሏ *lwa*. The letter ኸ is used in a few words only, so it has no page here.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the base letters ፊደል

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ሀ

NAME · ስም

ሀ

ha

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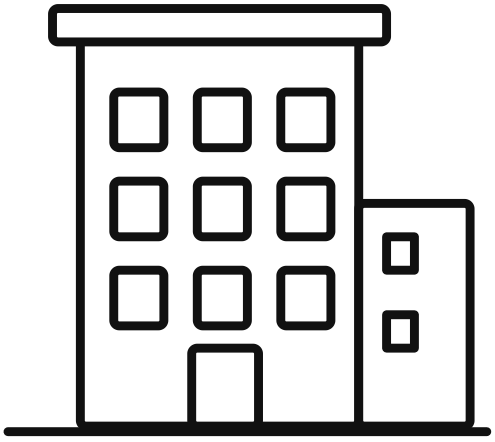
‘h’ as in “hat”

THE ሀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሀ	ሁ	ሂ	ሃ	ሄ	ህ	ሆ
ha 1st	*hu* 2nd	*hi* 3rd	*ha* 4th	*hé* 5th	*h(i)* 6th	*ho* 7th

ህ *hi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ህንፃ.

In Amharic ሀ ሐ ኀ all say ‘h’. Children tell them apart by their nicknames.



ሀ IS FOR

ህንፃ

hin-ts'a

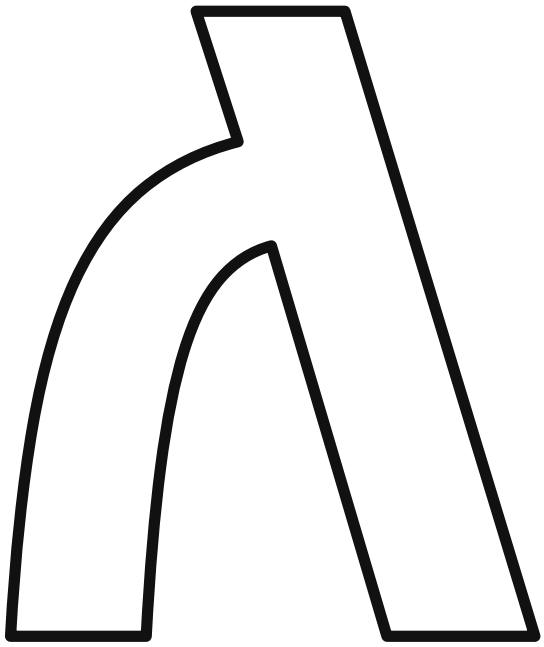
building

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ሀ ሀ ሀ ሀ

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NAME · ስም

ለ

le

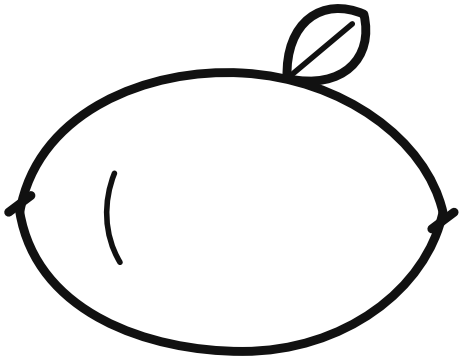
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

THE ለ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ለ	ሉ	ሊ	ላ	ሌ	ል	ሎ
le 1st	*lu* 2nd	*li* 3rd	*la* 4th	*lé* 5th	*l(i)* 6th	*lo* 7th

ሎ *lo*, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word ሎሚ.



ለ IS FOR

ሎሚ

lo-mi

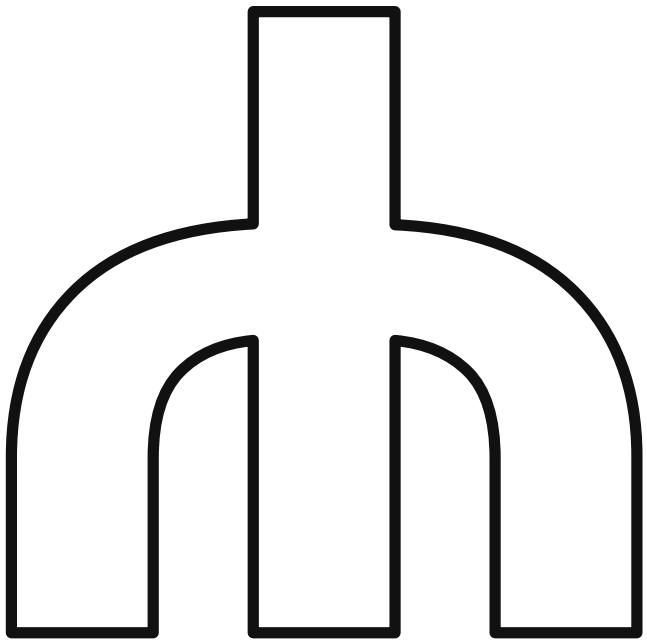
lemon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ለ ለ ለ ለ

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NAME · ስም

ሐመሩ ሐ

hameru ha

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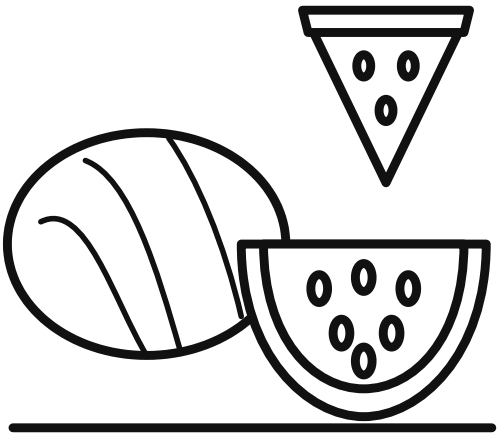
‘h’ as in “hat” — the same sound as ሀ

THE ሐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሐ	ሑ	ሒ	ሓ	ሔ	ሕ	ሖ
ha 1st	*hu* 2nd	*hi* 3rd	*ha* 4th	*hé* 5th	*h(i)* 6th	*ho* 7th

ሐ *ha*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሐብሐብ.

In Amharic ሀ ሐ ኀ all say ‘h’. Children tell them apart by their nicknames.



ሐ IS FOR

ሐብሐብ

hab-hab

watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ሐ ሐ ሐ ሐ

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መ

NAME · ስም

መ

me

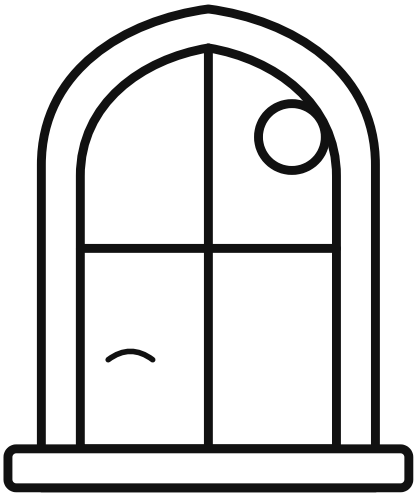
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'm' as in "moon"

THE መ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

መ	ሙ	ሚ	ማ	ሜ	ም	ሞ
me 1st	*mu* 2nd	*mi* 3rd	*ma* 4th	*mé* 5th	*m(i)* 6th	*mo* 7th

መ *me*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word መስኮት.



መ IS FOR

መስኮት

mes-kot

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

መ መ መ መ

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ሠ

NAME · ስም

ንጉሡ ሠ

negusu se

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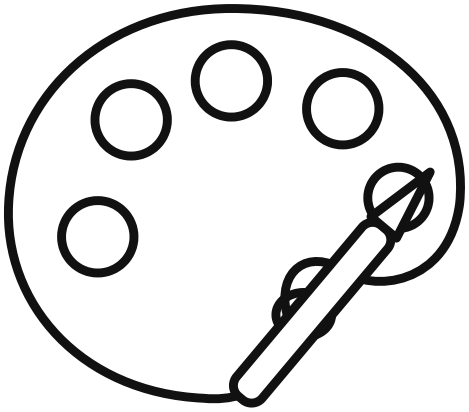
‘s’ as in “sun” — the same sound as ሰ

THE ሠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሠ	ሡ	ሢ	ሣ	ሤ	ሥ	ሦ
se 1st	*su* 2nd	*si* 3rd	*sa* 4th	*sé* 5th	*s(i)* 6th	*so* 7th

ሥ *si*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ሥዕል.

ሠ and ሰ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ሠ IS FOR

ሥዕል

si-'il

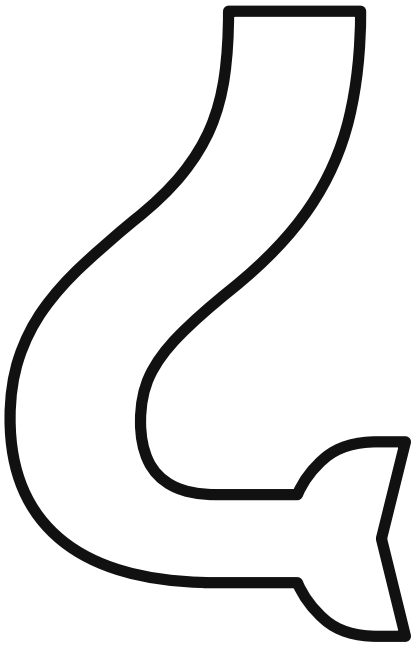
picture, painting

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ሠ ሠ ሠ ሠ

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NAME · ስም

ሬ

re

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick tapped ‘r’, as in Spanish “pero”

THE ሬ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሬ	ሩ	ሪ	ራ	ሬ	ር	ሮ
re 1st	*ru* 2nd	*ri* 3rd	*ra* 4th	*ré* 5th	*r(i)* 6th	*ro* 7th

ሩ *ru*, the **2nd** sound of this family, starts the word ሩዝ.



ሬ IS FOR

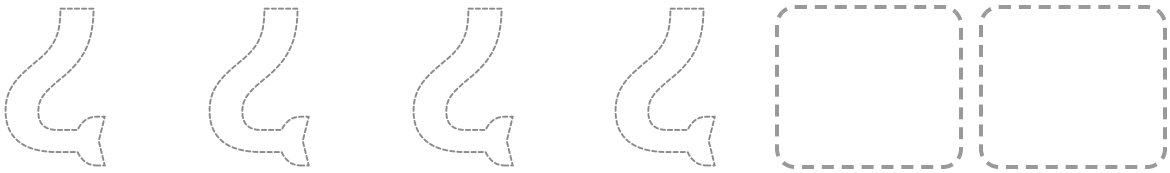
ሩዝ

ruz

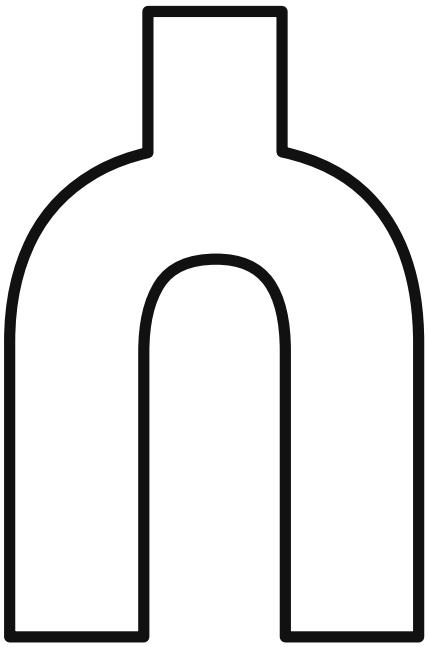
rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ



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NAME · ስም

እሳቱ ሰ

isatu se

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

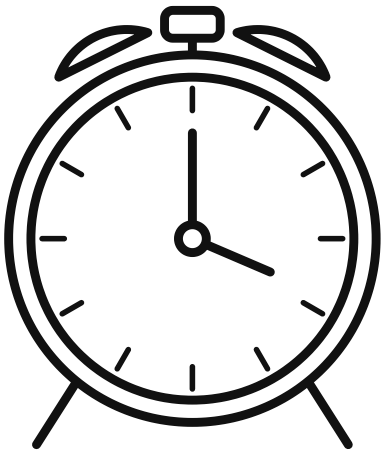
‘s’ as in “sun”

THE ሰ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሰ	ሱ	ሲ	ሳ	ሴ	ስ	ሶ
se 1st	*su* 2nd	*si* 3rd	*sa* 4th	*sé* 5th	*s(i)* 6th	*so* 7th

ሰ *se*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሰዓት.

Ⴝ and ሰ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ሰ IS FOR

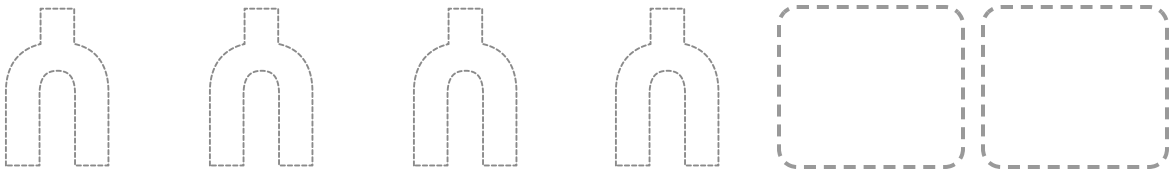
ሰዓት

se-'at

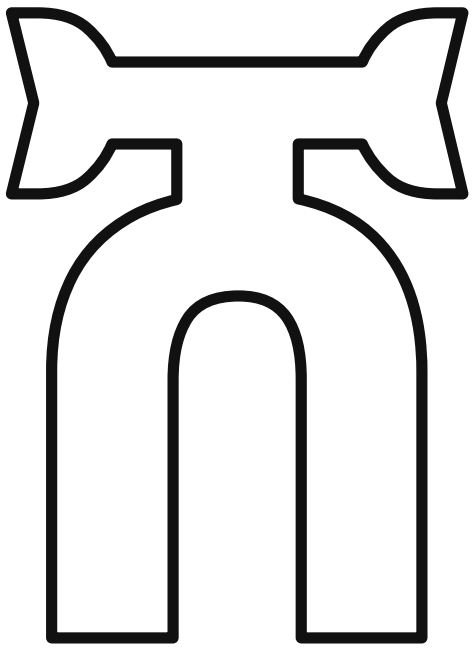
clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ



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NAME · ስም

ሸ

she

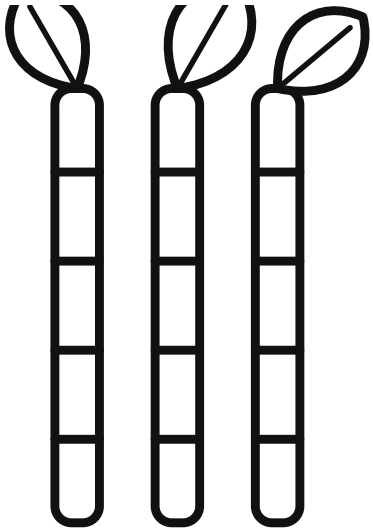
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “ship”

THE ሸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሸ	ሹ	ሺ	ሻ	ሼ	ሽ	ሾ
she 1st	*shu* 2nd	*shi* 3rd	*sha* 4th	*shé* 5th	*sh(i)* 6th	*sho* 7th

ሸ *she*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሸንኮራ.



ሸ IS FOR

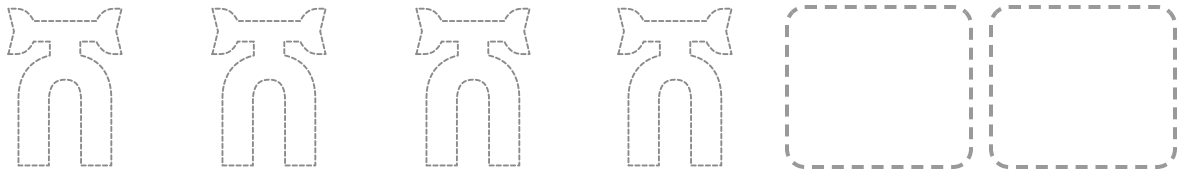
ሸንኮራ

shen-ko-ra

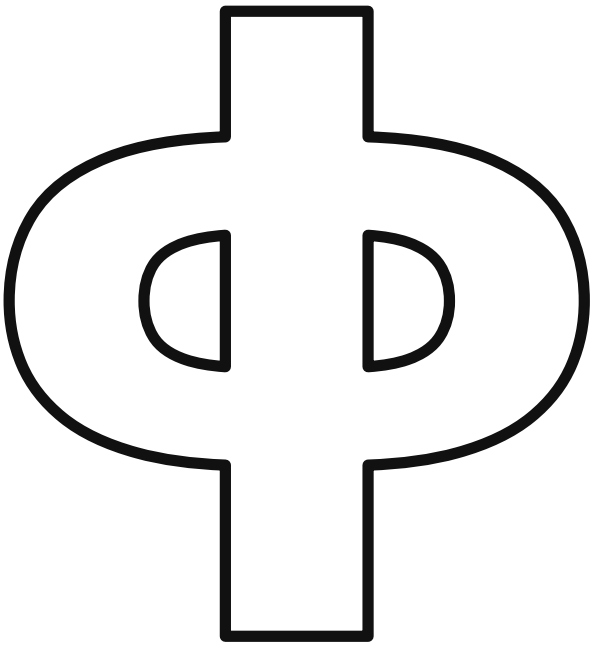
sugarcane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ



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NAME · ስም

ቀ

qe

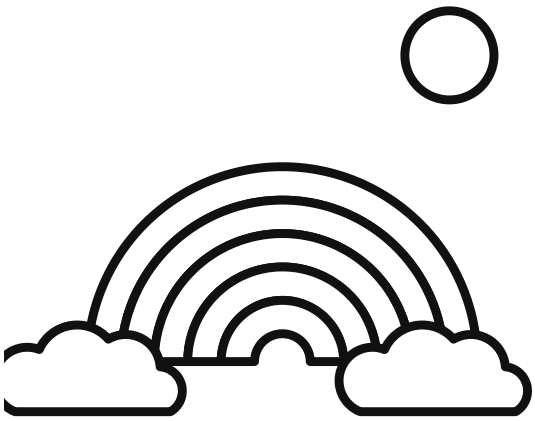
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘q’ — a ‘k’ said far back in the throat (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ቀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቀ	ቁ	ቂ	ቃ	ቄ	ቅ	ቆ
qe 1st	*qu* 2nd	*qi* 3rd	*qa* 4th	*qé* 5th	*q(i)* 6th	*qo* 7th

ቀ *qe*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ቀስተ ደመና.



ቀ IS FOR

ቀስተ ደመና

qes-te de-me-na

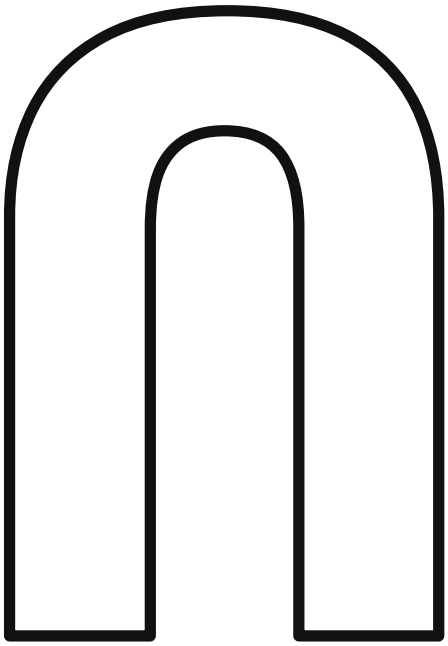
rainbow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ቀ ቀ ቀ ቀ

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NAME · ስም

በ

be

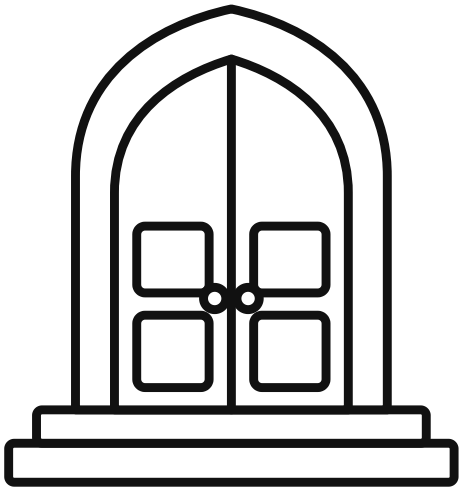
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

THE በ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

በ	ቡ	ቢ	ባ	ቤ	ብ	ቦ
be 1st	*bu* 2nd	*bi* 3rd	*ba* 4th	*bé* 5th	*b(i)* 6th	*bo* 7th

በ *be*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word በር.



በ IS FOR

በር

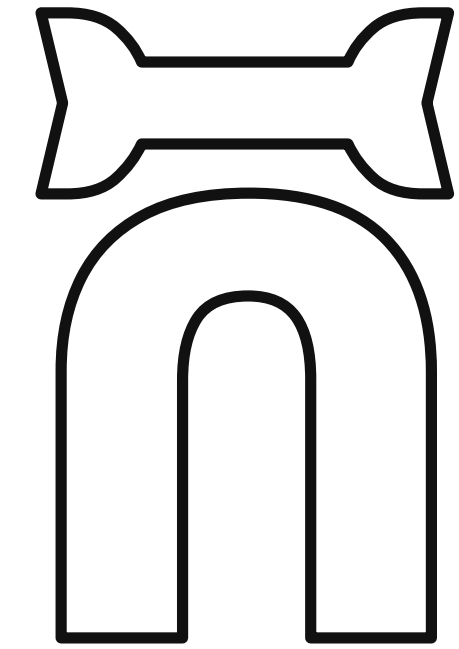
ber

door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

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NAME · ስም

ቨ

ve

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

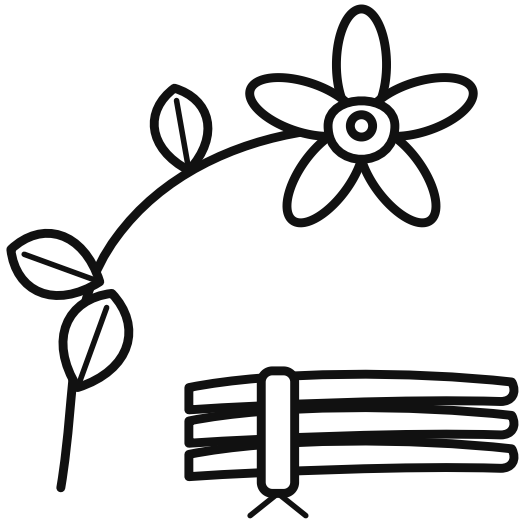
‘v’ as in “van”

THE ቨ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቨ	ቩ	ቪ	ቫ	ቬ	ቭ	ቮ
ve 1st	*vu* 2nd	*vi* 3rd	*va* 4th	*vé* 5th	*v(i)* 6th	*vo* 7th

ቫ *va*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ቫኒላ.

ቨ is a newer letter, used only in words borrowed from other languages.



ቨ IS FOR

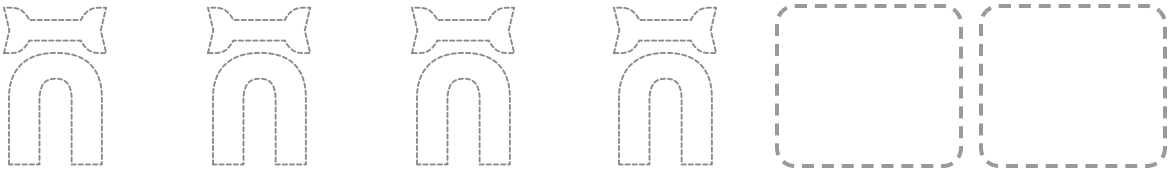
ቫኒላ

va-ni-la

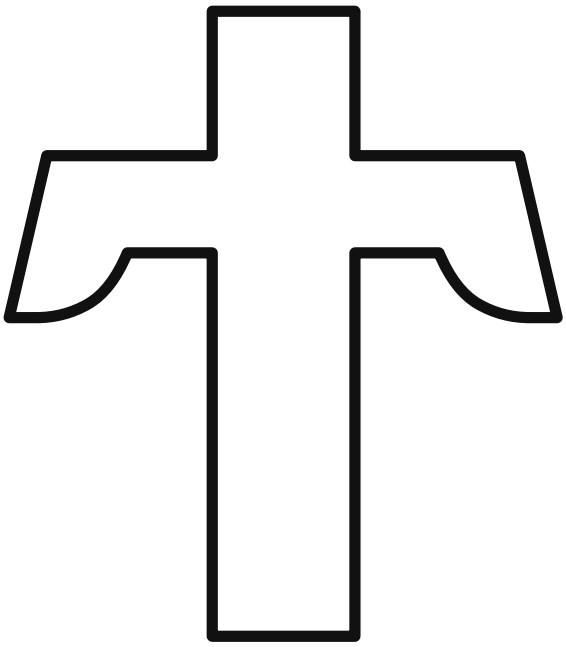
vanilla (a climbing plant with sweet pods)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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NAME · ስም

ተ

te

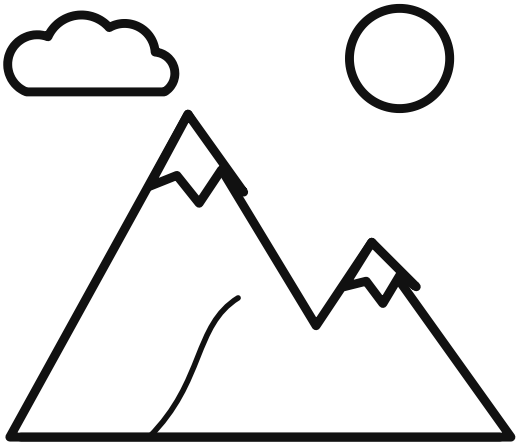
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”

THE ተ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ተ	ቱ	ቲ	ታ	ቴ	ት	ቶ
te 1st	*tu* 2nd	*ti* 3rd	*ta* 4th	*té* 5th	*t(i)* 6th	*to* 7th

ተ *te*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ተራራ.



ተ IS FOR

ተራራ

te-ra-ra

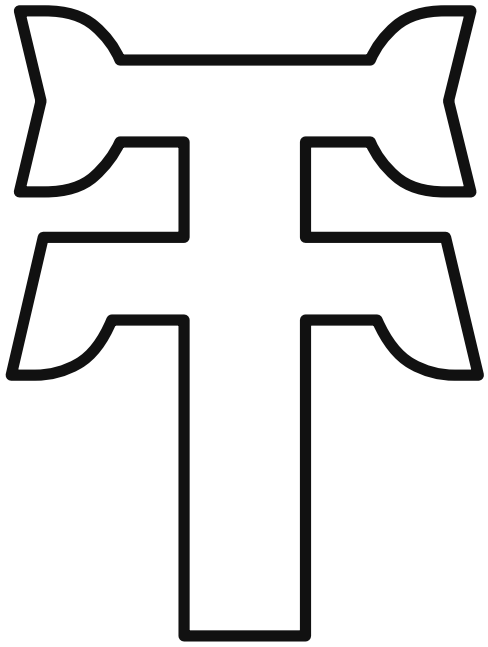
mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ተ ተ ተ ተ

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NAME · ስም

ቸ

che

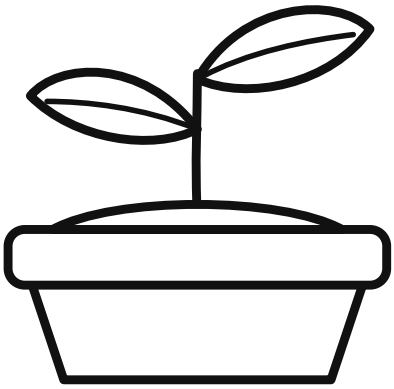
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

THE ቸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቸ	ቹ	ቺ	ቻ	ቼ	ች	ቾ
che 1st	*chu* 2nd	*chi* 3rd	*cha* 4th	*ché* 5th	*ch(i)* 6th	*cho* 7th

ች *chi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ችግኝ.



ቸ IS FOR

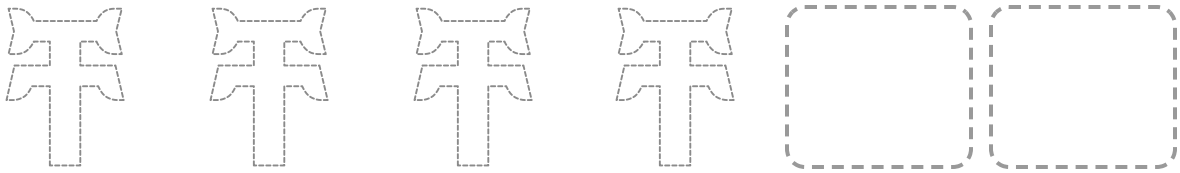
ችግኝ

chi-giny

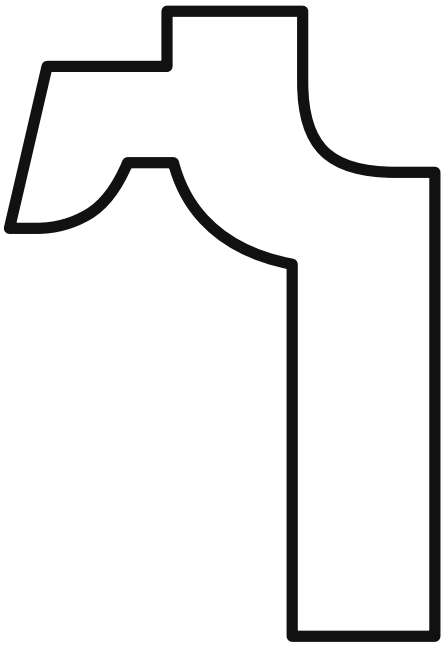
seedling, a young plant

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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NAME · ስም

ብዙኅኑ ኀ

bizuhanu ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

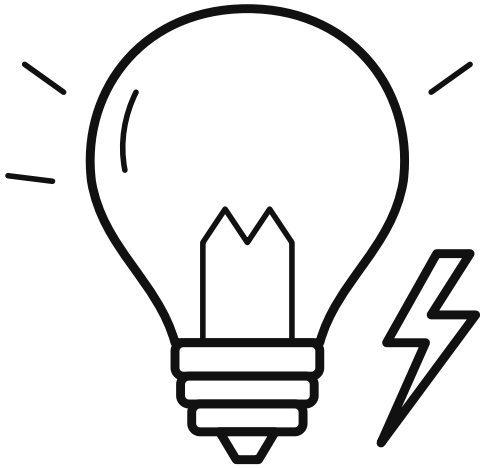
‘h’ as in “hat” — the same sound as ሀ

THE ኀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ኀ	ኁ	ኂ	ኃ	ኄ	ኅ	ኆ
ha 1st	*hu* 2nd	*hi* 3rd	*ha* 4th	*hé* 5th	*h(i)* 6th	*ho* 7th

ኃ *ha*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ኃይል.

ኀ is the rarest of the three h-letters. Children tell them apart by their nicknames.



ኀ IS FOR

ኃይል

hayl

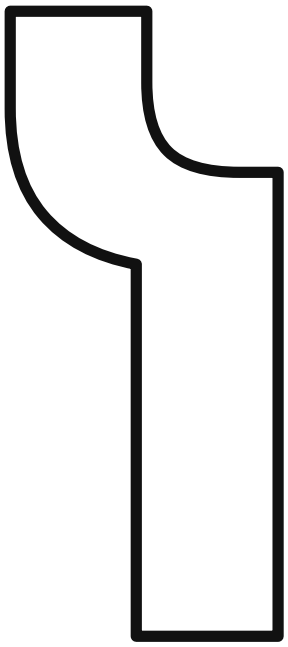
power, energy

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ኀ ኀ ኀ ኀ

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NAME · ስም

ነ

ne

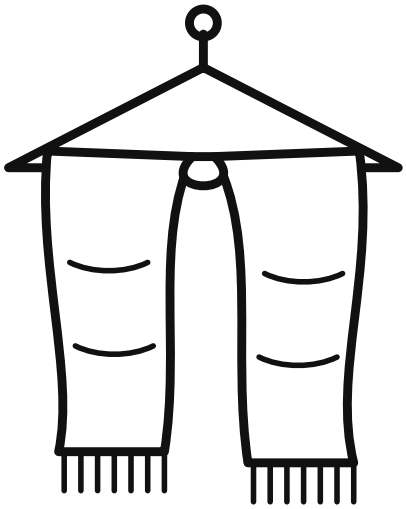
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

THE ነ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ነ	ኑ	ኒ	ና	ኔ	ን	ኖ
ne 1st	*nu* 2nd	*ni* 3rd	*na* 4th	*né* 5th	*n(i)* 6th	*no* 7th

ነ *ne*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ነጠላ.



ነ IS FOR

ነጠላ

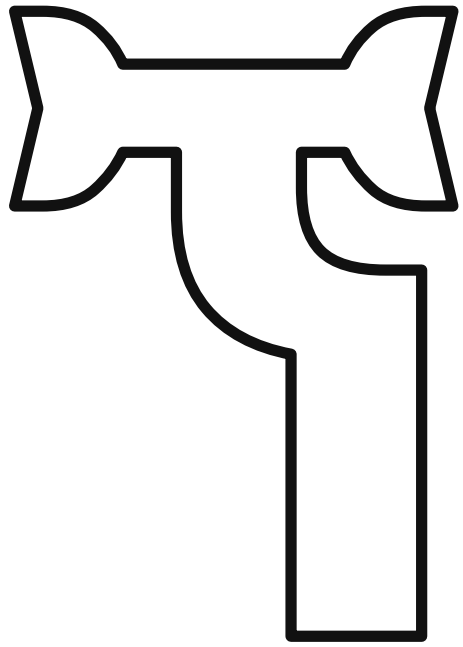
ne-t'e-la

netela, a light cotton shawl

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

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NAME · ስም

ኘ

nye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

THE ኘ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ኘ	ኙ	ኚ	ኛ	ኜ	ኝ	ኞ
nye 1st	*nyu* 2nd	*nyi* 3rd	*nya* 4th	*nyé* 5th	*ny(i)* 6th	*nyo* 7th

ኛ *nya*, the **4th** sound of this family, is found inside the word አማርኛ.

ኘ hardly ever starts a word. Find ኛ at the end of አማርኛ!



ኘ IS FOR

አማርኛ

a-ma-ri-nya

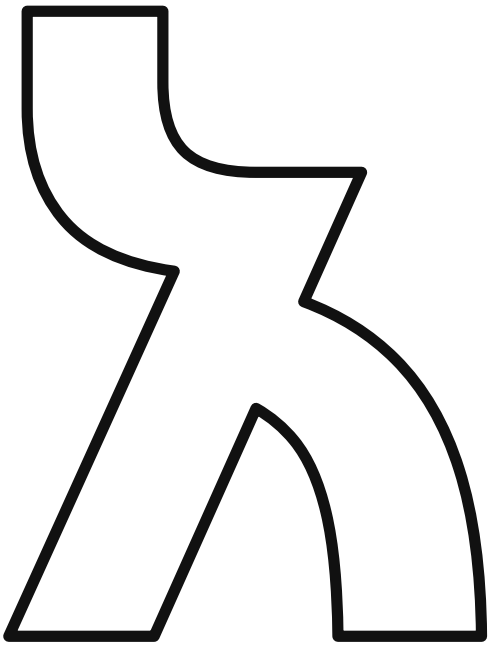
Amharic — the language of this book!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ኘ ኘ ኘ ኘ

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NAME · ስም

አልፋው አ

alfaw a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

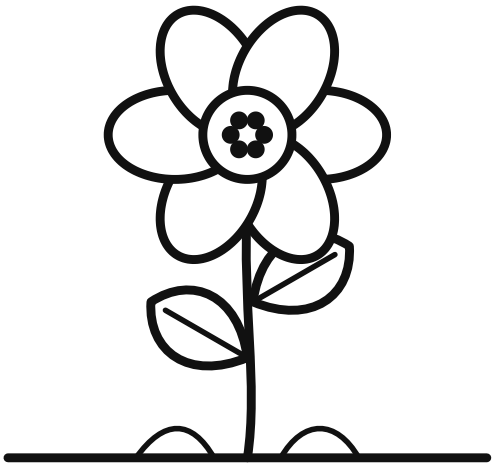
the vowel ‘a’ as in “father” — this family writes the vowels on their own

THE አ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

አ	ኡ	ኢ	ኣ	ኤ	እ	ኦ
a 1st	*u* 2nd	*i* 3rd	*a* 4th	*é* 5th	*i* 6th	*o* 7th

አ *a*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word አበባ.

አ and ዐ sound the same in Amharic; each is kept in its own words.



አ IS FOR

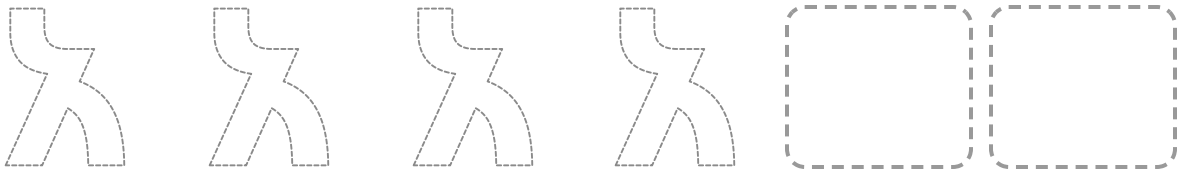
አበባ

a-be-ba

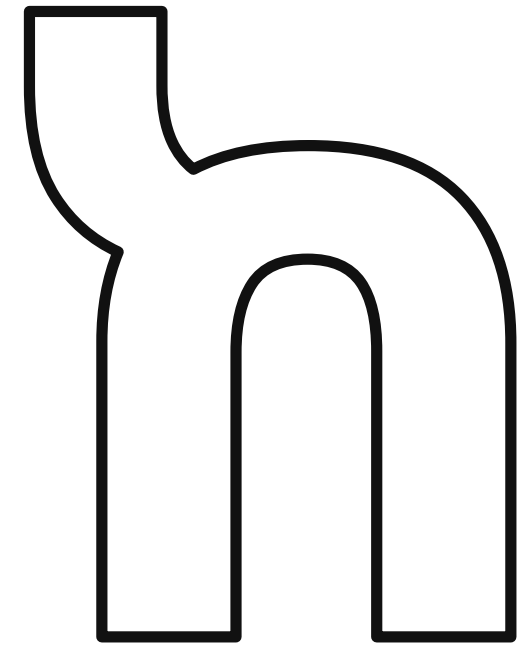
flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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NAME · ስም

ከ

ke

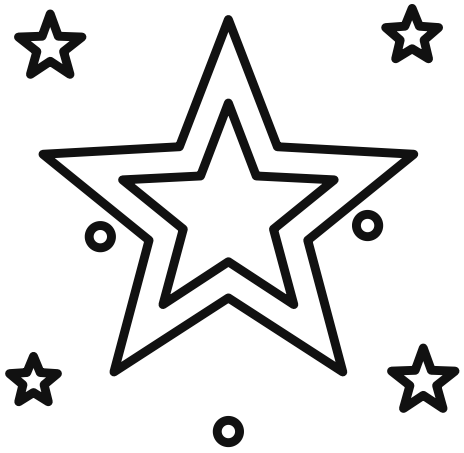
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

THE ከ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ከ	ኩ	ኪ	ካ	ኬ	ክ	ኮ
ke 1st	*ku* 2nd	*ki* 3rd	*ka* 4th	*ké* 5th	*k(i)* 6th	*ko* 7th

ኮ *ko*, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word ኮከብ.



ከ IS FOR

ኮከብ

ko-keb

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ከ ከ ከ ከ

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ወ

NAME · ስም

ወ

we

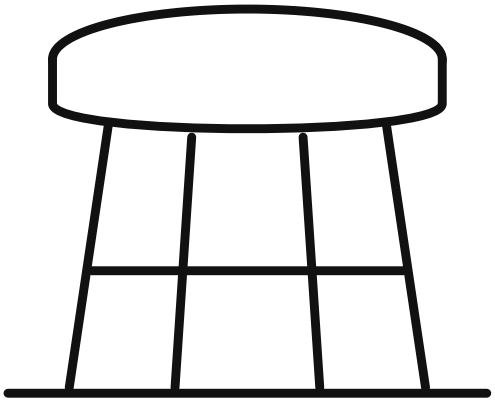
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'w' as in "water"

THE ወ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ወ	ዉ	ዊ	ዋ	ዌ	ው	ዎ
we 1st	*wu* 2nd	*wi* 3rd	*wa* 4th	*wé* 5th	*w(i)* 6th	*wo* 7th

ወ *we*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ወንበር.



ወ IS FOR

ወንበር

wen-ber

chair, stool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ወ ወ ወ ወ

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ዐ

NAME · ስም

ዓይኑ 0

aynu a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

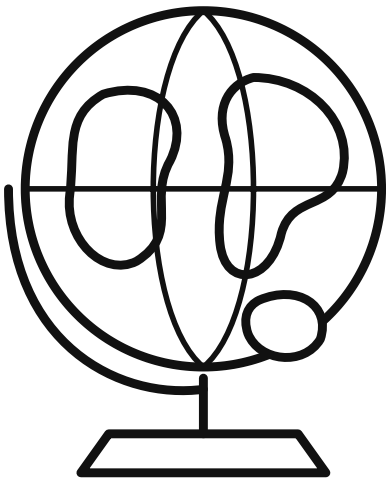
the vowel ‘a’ — the same sound as አ

THE 0 FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

0	ዑ	ዒ	ዓ	ዔ	ዕ	ዖ
a 1st	*u* 2nd	*i* 3rd	*a* 4th	*é* 5th	*i* 6th	*o* 7th

ዓ *a*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ዓለም.

አ and 0 sound the same in Amharic; each is kept in its own words.



0 IS FOR

ዓለም

a-lem

the world

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

0 0 0 0

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ዘ

NAME · ስም

ዘ

ze

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

THE ዘ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ዘ	ዙ	ዚ	ዛ	ዜ	ዝ	ዞ
ze 1st	*zu* 2nd	*zi* 3rd	*za* 4th	*zé* 5th	*z(i)* 6th	*zo* 7th

ዝ *zi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ዝናብ.



ዘ IS FOR

ዝናብ

zi-nab

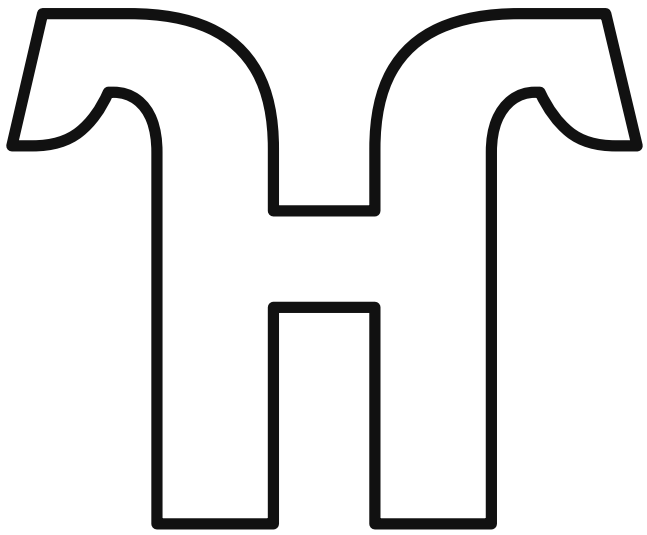
rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ዘ ዘ ዘ ዘ

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NAME · ስም

ዠ

zhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘zh’ like the ‘s’ in “measure” — a rare letter

THE ዠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ዠ	ዡ	ዢ	ዣ	ዤ	ዥ	ዦ
zhe 1st	*zhu* 2nd	*zhi* 3rd	*zha* 4th	*zhé* 5th	*zh(i)* 6th	*zho* 7th

ዠ *zha*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ዣንጥላ.



ዠ IS FOR

ዣንጥላ

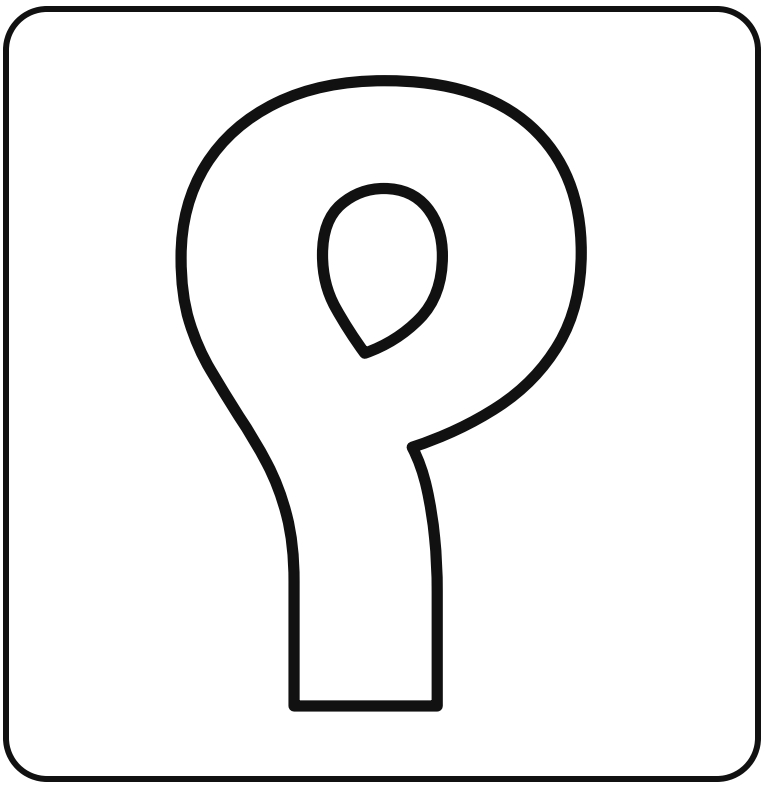
zhan-t'i-la

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

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NAME · ስም

የ

ye

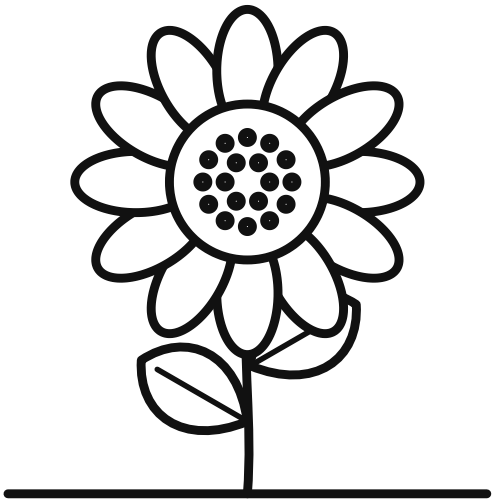
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

THE የ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

የ	ዩ	ዪ	ያ	ዬ	ይ	ዮ
ye 1st	*yu* 2nd	*yi* 3rd	*ya* 4th	*yé* 5th	*y(i)* 6th	*yo* 7th

የ *ye*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word የሱፍ አበባ.



የ IS FOR

የሱፍ አበባ

ye-suf a-be-ba

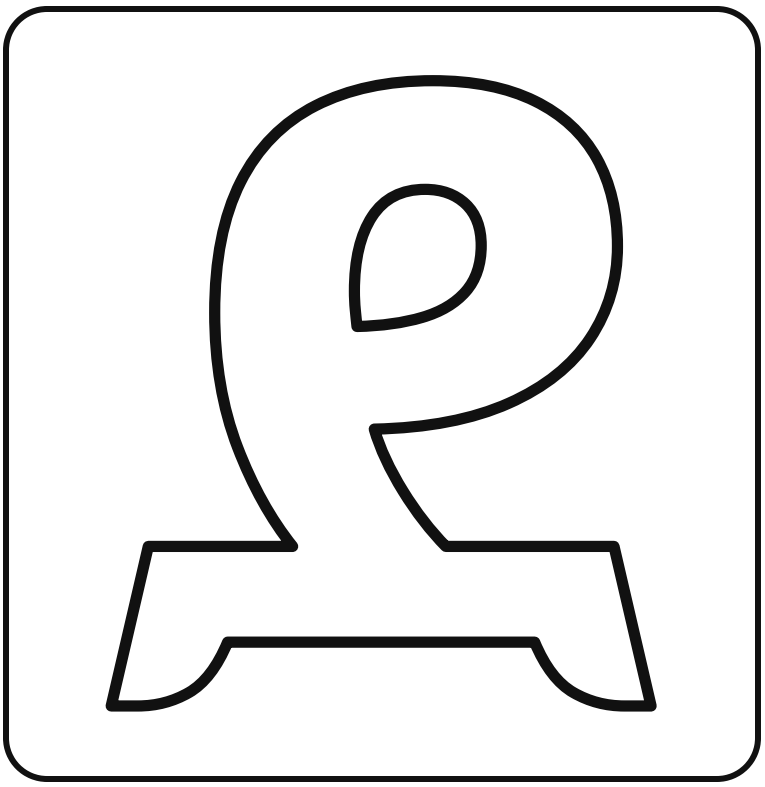
sunflower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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NAME · ስም

ደ

de

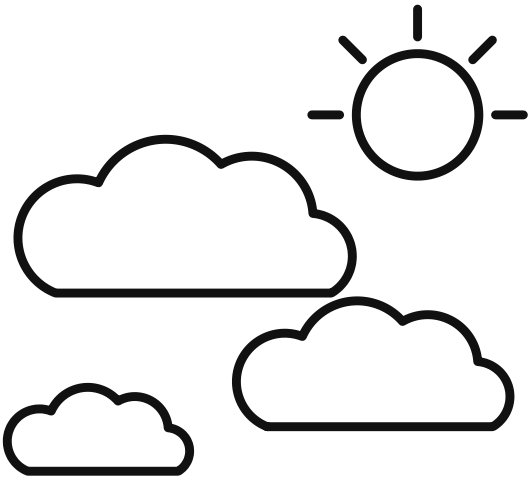
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “door”

THE ደ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ደ	ዱ	ዲ	ዳ	ዴ	ድ	ዶ
de 1st	*du* 2nd	*di* 3rd	*da* 4th	*dé* 5th	*d(i)* 6th	*do* 7th

ደ *de*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ደመና.



ደ IS FOR

ደመና

de-me-na

cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ደ ደ ደ ደ

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ጀ

NAME · ስም

ጀ

je

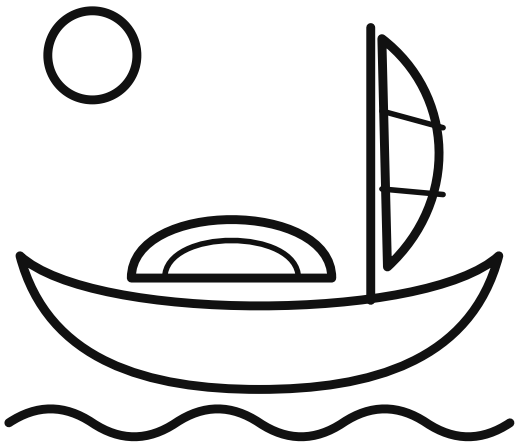
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

THE ጀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጀ	ጁ	ጂ	ጃ	ጄ	ጅ	ጆ
je 1st	*ju* 2nd	*ji* 3rd	*ja* 4th	*jé* 5th	*j(i)* 6th	*jo* 7th

ጀ *je*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጀልባ.



ጀ IS FOR

ጀልባ

jel-ba

boat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ጀ ጀ ጀ ጀ

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ገ

NAME · ስም

ገ

ge

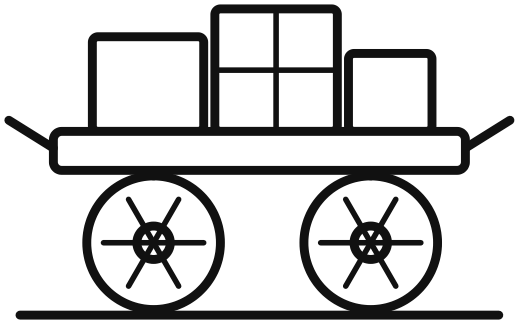
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

THE ገ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ገ	ጉ	ጊ	ጋ	ጌ	ግ	ጎ
ge 1st	*gu* 2nd	*gi* 3rd	*ga* 4th	*gé* 5th	*g(i)* 6th	*go* 7th

ጋ *ga*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ጋሪ.



ገ IS FOR

ጋሪ

ga-ri

cart

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ገ ገ ገ ገ

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ጠ

NAME · ስም

ጠ

t'e

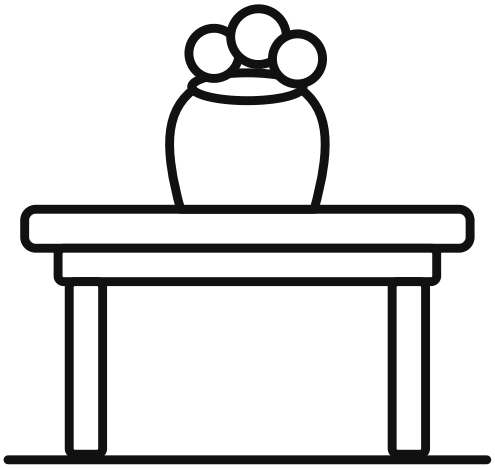
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘t’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጠ	ጡ	ጢ	ጣ	ጤ	ጥ	ጦ
t'e 1st	*t'u* 2nd	*t'i* 3rd	*t'a* 4th	*t'é* 5th	*t'(i)* 6th	*t'o* 7th

ጠ *t'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጠረጴዛ.



ጠ IS FOR

ጠረጴዛ

t'e-re-p'é-za

table

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

ጠ ጠ ጠ ጠ

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ቸ ቸ ቸ

NAME · ስም

ቸ

ch'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘ch’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ቸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቸ	ቹ	ቺ	ቻ	ቼ	ች	ቾ
ch'e 1st	*ch'u* 2nd	*ch'i* 3rd	*ch'a* 4th	*ch'é* 5th	*ch'(i)* 6th	*ch'o* 7th

ቸ *ch'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ቸረቃ.



ቸ IS FOR

ቸረቃ

ch'e-re-qa

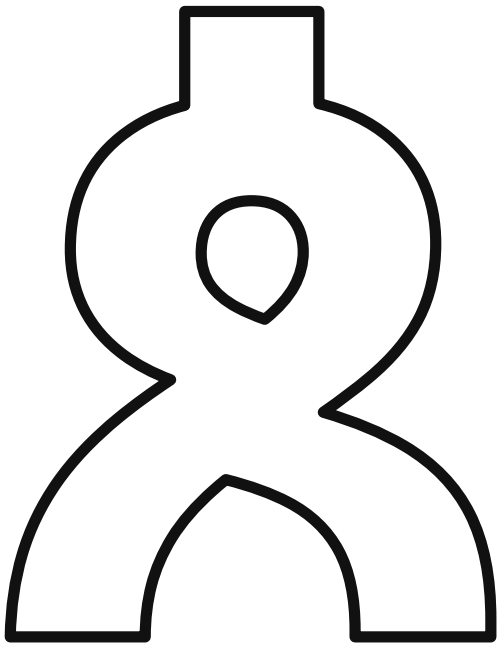
moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ቸ ቸ ቸ ቸ

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NAME · ስም

ጰ

p'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

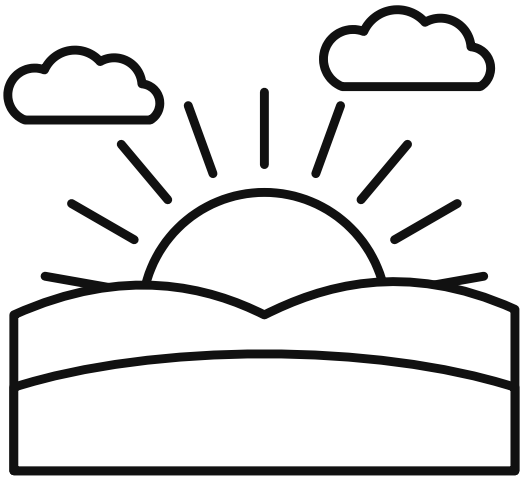
a popped ‘p’ — a rare letter (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጰ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጰ	ጱ	ጲ	ጳ	ጴ	ጵ	ጶ
p'e 1st	*p'u* 2nd	*p'i* 3rd	*p'a* 4th	*p'é* 5th	*p'(i)* 6th	*p'o* 7th

ጳ *p'a*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ጳጉሜ.

The Ethiopian calendar has 13 months: twelve of 30 days, then ጳጉሜ with 5 or 6 days.



ጰ IS FOR

ጳጉሜ

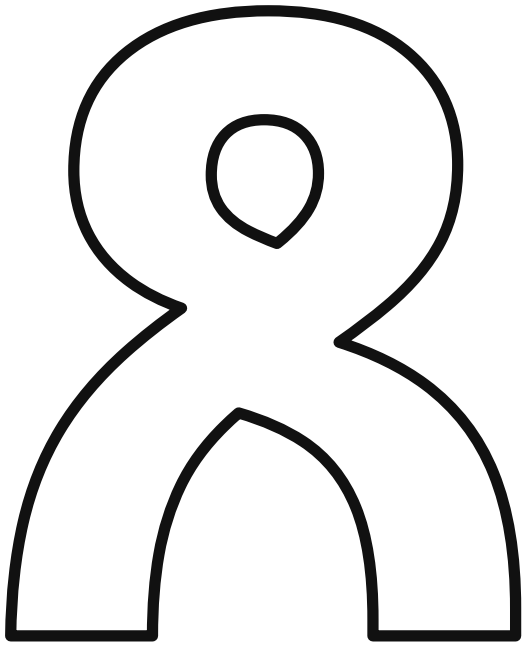
p'a-gu-mé

Pagumé, the short 13th month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጰፍ

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NAME · ስም

ጸሎቱ ጸ

ts'elotu ts'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

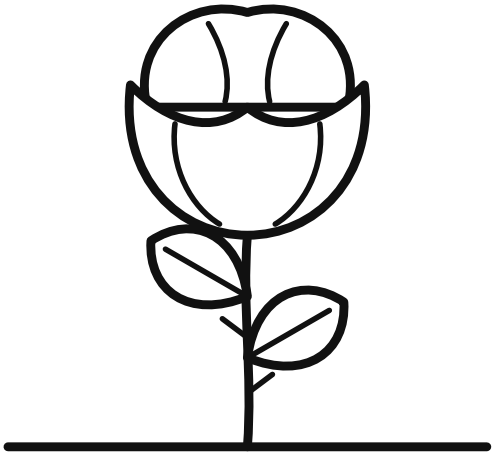
a popped ‘ts’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጸ	ጹ	ጺ	ጻ	ጼ	ጽ	ጾ
ts'e 1st	*ts'u* 2nd	*ts'i* 3rd	*ts'a* 4th	*ts'é* 5th	*ts'(i)* 6th	*ts'o* 7th

ጽ *ts'i*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ጽጌረዳ.

ጸ and ፀ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ጸ IS FOR

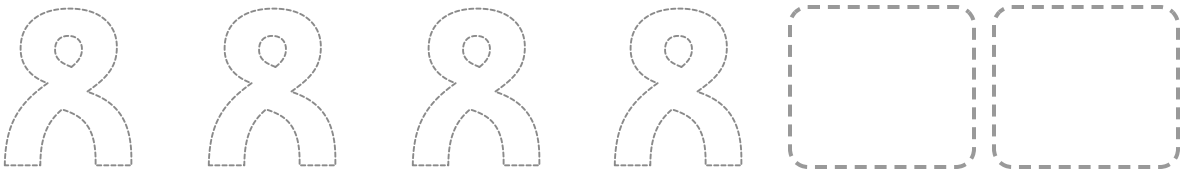
ጽጌረዳ

ts'i-gé-re-da

rose

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ



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ፀ

NAME · ስም

ፀሐዩ ፀ

ts'ehayu ts'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

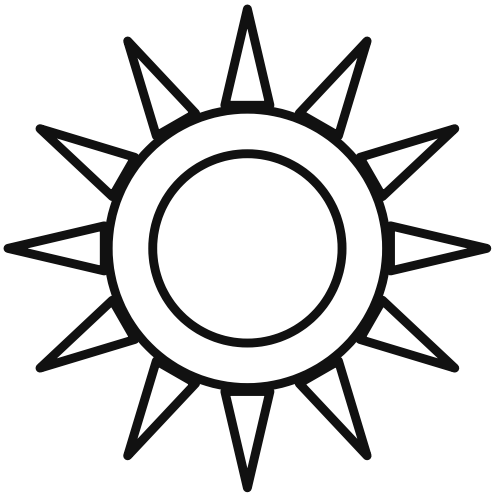
a popped ‘ts’ — the same sound as ጸ

THE ፀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ፀ	ፁ	ፂ	ፃ	ፄ	ፅ	ፆ
ts'e 1st	*ts'u* 2nd	*ts'i* 3rd	*ts'a* 4th	*ts'é* 5th	*ts'(i)* 6th	*ts'o* 7th

ፀ *ts'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ፀሐይ.

ጸ and ፀ sound the same; each is kept in its own words.



ፀ IS FOR

ፀሐይ

ts'e-hay

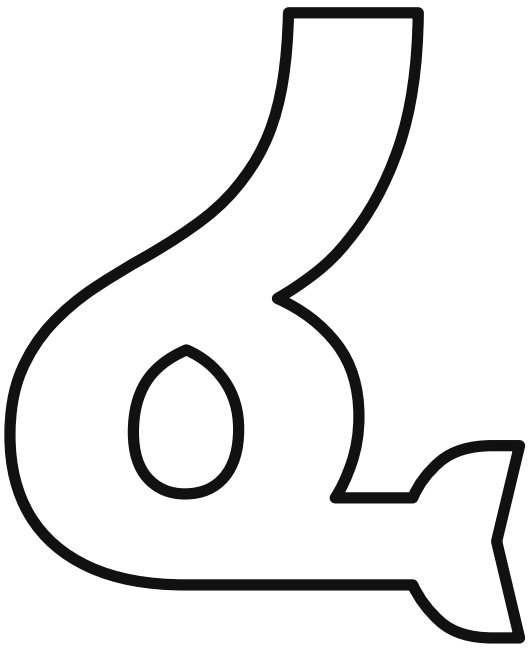
sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

ፀ ፀ ፀ ፀ

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NAME · ስም

ፈ

fe

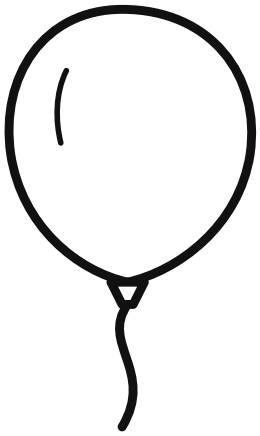
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

THE ፈ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ፈ	ፉ	ፊ	ፋ	ፌ	ፍ	ፎ
fe 1st	*fu* 2nd	*fi* 3rd	*fa* 4th	*fé* 5th	*f(i)* 6th	*fo* 7th

ፊ *fi*, the **3rd** sound of this family, starts the word ፊኛ.



ፈ IS FOR

ፊኛ

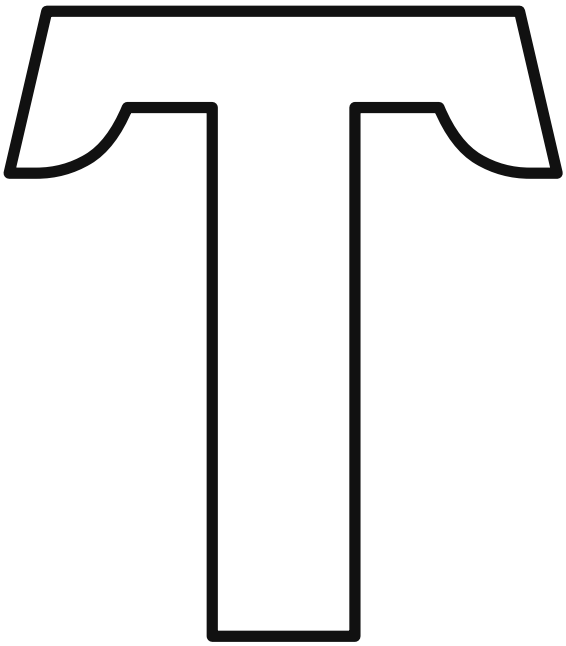
fi-nya

balloon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጸፍ

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NAME · ስም

ፐ

pe

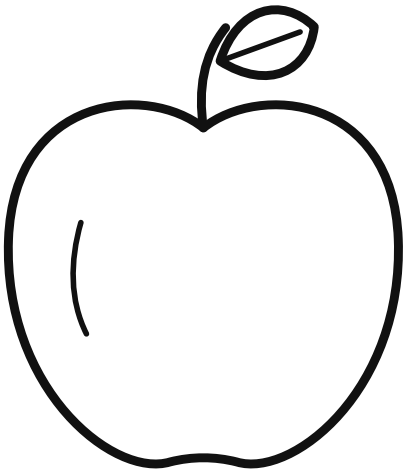
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

THE ፐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ፐ	ፑ	ፒ	ፓ	ፔ	ፕ	ፖ
pe 1st	*pu* 2nd	*pi* 3rd	*pa* 4th	*pé* 5th	*p(i)* 6th	*po* 7th

ፖ po, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word *ፖም*.



ፐ IS FOR

ፖም

pom

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጻፍ

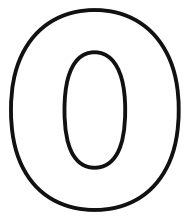
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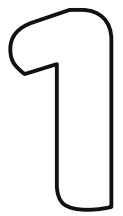
BONUS

Amharic numbers ቁጥሮች *(qu-t'i-roch)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Amharic: *zé-ro, and, hu-let, sost...*



0
ዜሮ
zé-ro
zero



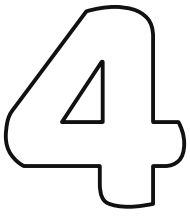
1
አንድ
and
one · ፩



2
ሁለት
hu-let
two · ፪



3
ሦስት
sost
three · ፫



4
አራት
a-rat
four · ፬



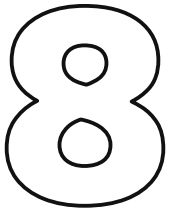
5
አምስት
a-mist
five · ፭



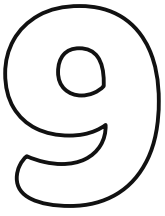
6
ስድስት
sid-ist
six · ፮



7
ሰባት
se-bat
seven · ፯



8
ስምንት
si-mint
eight · ፰



9
ዘጠኝ
ze-t'eny
nine · ፱

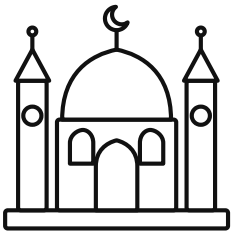
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LET'S TALK

My first Amharic words የመጀመሪያ ቃላት

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

አሰላሙ ዐለይኩም	*as-se-la-mu a-ley-kum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
ወዐለይኩም አሰላም	*we-a-ley-kum as-se-lam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
ሰላም!	*se-lam!* **Hello!**
ስሜ ... ነው	*si-mé ... new* **My name is ...**
አመሰግናለሁ	*a-me-se-gi-na-le-hu* **Thank you**
ጀዛከላሁ ኸይራን	*je-za-ke-la-hu khey-ran* **May Allah reward you with good**
እናት · አባት	*i-nat · a-bat* **Mother · Father**
ወንድም · እህት	*wen-dim · i-hit* **Brother · Sister**
አዎ · አይ	*a-wo · ay* **Yes · No**
አማርኛ እየተማርኩ ነው!	*a-ma-ri-nya i-ye-te-mar-ku new!* **I am learning Amharic!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

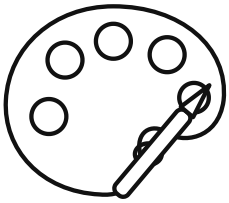
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded; first- and second-language speakers together.

What's next?
You have met all **33 Amharic letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Amharic, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ማሻአላህ! በጣም ጎበዝ!

ma-sha-al-lah! be-t'am go-bez! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 33 letters of the Amharic alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.